THE RAMAKRISHNA CENTRE OF SOUTH AFRICA
– JOHANNESBURG –

THE IMPORTANCE OF SPIRITUAL EDUCATION *for Children*





DATE:
Sunday, 16 August 2026

TIME:
10h00 – 12h30

VENUE:
Vodaworld at Vodacom Office Park

ATTENDEE: _____

> “We want that education by which character is formed, strength of mind is increased, the intellect is expanded, and by which one can stand on one’s own feet.”
>
> — Swami Vivekananda

GUIDELINES FOR CHILDREN

These guidelines are meant for the overall personality development of a child. The ideal is to help children develop broad-mindedness and depth of character.



THREE CHARITIES

1. **BODY:** I shall be charitable to my body by keeping it neat and clean.
2. **MIND:** I shall be charitable to my mind by speaking the truth.
3. **SOUL:** I shall be charitable to my soul by praying regularly.



THREE VIRTUES

1. **BODY:** I shall be virtuous to my body by keeping it healthy.
2. **MIND:** I shall be virtuous to my mind by loving all.
3. **SOUL:** I shall be virtuous to my soul by remembering God.



THREE SERVICES

1. **BODY:** I shall be of service to my body by doing good acts.
2. **MIND:** I shall be of service to my mind by being kind to all.
3. **SOUL:** I shall be of service to my soul by loving God.



THREE DEEDS

1. **CREATURES:** I shall be gentle and kind to all creatures.
2. **PARENTS:** I shall obey and serve my parents.
3. **GOD:** I shall be truthful to God in thought, word and deed.

SPIRITUAL EDUCATION AT HOME

1. WHY SPIRITUAL EDUCATION IS IMPORTANT FOR CHILDREN

- It builds good character and strong values.
- It develops inner strength, self-confidence and discipline.
- It teaches love, compassion and respect for all.
- It gives children a sense of purpose and meaning.
- It helps them face challenges with courage and peace.
- It lays the foundation for a happy and balanced life.

2. SIMPLE PRACTICES PARENTS CAN FOLLOW AT HOME

- Begin and end the day with a short prayer together.
- Read inspiring stories from the lives of great souls.
- Encourage gratitude – let children say "Thank you" to God daily.
- Keep a small altar or sacred space at home.
- Observe one family value of the week (e.g. truthfulness, kindness, respect).
- Involve children in simple acts of service and charity.
- Limit screen time and create quiet time for reflection.
- Parents should be role models in thought, word and action.

3. HOW TO ANSWER DIFFICULT QUESTIONS

- Listen patiently and with love.
- Be honest – if you don't know, say so.
- Answer according to the child's age and understanding.
- Use simple examples, stories and everyday experiences.
- Avoid giving confusing or contradictory answers.
- Encourage curiosity and help them think for themselves.
- Pray together – many answers come with time and grace.



"Education is the manifestation of the perfection already in man." – Swami Vivekananda –

GUIDELINES FOR STUDENTS

1. **Take care of your health** – regular exercise, pure food, and a balanced life.
2. **Be disciplined** and make the best use of your time.
3. **Study sincerely** and develop a love for knowledge.
4. **Speak the truth** and be honest in all your dealings.
5. **Respect your parents,** teachers and elders.
6. **Be kind and helpful** to friends and to all beings.
7. **Keep good company** and avoid harmful habits.
8. **Control your mind** and senses: practise self-restraint.
9. **Serve others selflessly** – "Service to man is service to God."
10. **Pray, meditate** and remember God daily.



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TO SUPPORT OUR WORK

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